9. Reforming the Planning Process

The Government called this Plan a ‘reform plan’ rather than a ‘resource plan’. There has been a long-standing criticism about Indian plans that they are mere excercises in the resource mobilisation. Probably, the PC has tried to do away with this criticism. The above given seven points visibly prove that the Tenth Plan was not merely a ‘resource plan’. Basically, the Plan initiates many pathbreaking changes in the planning process–its methods, strategies and the ideas–all at the same time. Rightly, it has been called a ‘reform plan’ by the PC. Second, this was the first plan in the era of economic reforms which accepts to go for establishing relevance to the process of the economic reforms. From this perspective, too, this Plan is a ‘reform plan’.

The inclusion of the above-given new elements into the Indian planning process has gone to really change the nature, role and scope of planning in the country. All these new elements are today carried forward by the Eleventh Plan with an emphasis wherever it is required. The planning process is more grown up today in India as the changes in the political arrangements at the centre do not seem to be affecting it unlike the past.

A CRITICAL EVALUATION

Planning has been subject to a number of criticisms right since its inception in the country. With the passage of time, not only the number of criticism increased but more importantly the shortcomings of planning were pointed out. Although after considerable delay, but the Governments took note of the shortcomings besides taking some major steps. The criticisms stand even today but with one difference that the Government is not only conscious of them but also trying to do away with them. We may briefly discuss the major criticisms of planning in India as well as the follow ups from the Government to do away with them as under:

1. Lack of ‘Perspective’ in Planning